

THE PETWISE QUICK GUIDE

7 things every dog parent should know

A simple, save-on-your-phone guide to noticing changes, sharing food more safely, and keeping important pet information in one place.

Your dog cannot explain when something feels different.
Knowing what is normal for them helps you notice when something changes.

The little things your pet can't tell you.

FREE QUICK GUIDE

Know Your Dog's Normal

The most useful baseline is not what is 'normal for dogs' - it is what is normal for your dog.

APPETITE	How much and how eagerly do they normally eat?
WATER	How often do they drink, and has that pattern changed?
ENERGY	What is their usual interest in walks, play and attention?
BATHROOM	Know their usual frequency, stool and urination habits.
SLEEP	Where, when and how much do they normally rest?
BEHAVIOR	Are they usually social, independent, playful, calm or vocal?
MOVEMENT	Notice their normal gait, stairs, jumping and getting up.

PETWISE TIP: A sudden, persistent or concerning change from your dog's usual pattern is worth paying attention to.

Try taking a few notes about your dog's normal habits today. A baseline is much easier to recognize before you need it.

5 Changes Worth Noticing

1. Less active

Less interest in walks, play, stairs or jumping.

2. Sleeping or hiding more

A noticeable change in rest or where they choose to spend time.

3. Appetite or drinking changes

Eating or drinking noticeably more or less than usual.

4. Behavior changes

New withdrawal, restlessness, irritability or reduced interest in attention.

5. Movement or posture changes

Limping, stiffness, difficulty getting up or an unusual posture.

IMPORTANT: These signs do not diagnose a condition. If a change is sudden, severe, persistent, worsening, or simply concerns you, contact your veterinarian.

Can My Dog Eat This?

A quick reference for a few common foods. Portions, preparation, individual health needs and ingredients still matter.

Blueberries	GENERALLY OK	Plain, washed, small portions.
Carrots	GENERALLY OK	Plain; cut appropriately for your dog.
Plain pumpkin	GENERALLY OK	Use plain pumpkin, not pie filling.
Peanut butter	CHECK FIRST	Must be xylitol/birch-sugar free.
Cheese	LIMIT	Small amounts; some dogs do not tolerate dairy.
Grapes / raisins	AVOID	Potentially toxic - seek veterinary guidance after ingestion.
Chocolate	AVOID	Toxicity varies by type, amount and dog size.
Onion / garlic	AVOID	Unsafe in raw, cooked, powdered or dried forms.

If your dog eats a potentially toxic food, do not wait for symptoms to appear. Contact your veterinarian or a pet poison service for case-specific guidance.

Common Household Hazards

Human foods

Grapes/raisins, chocolate, onions/garlic and products containing xylitol.

Medications

Human prescription and over-the-counter medicines should be stored securely.

Cleaning products

Keep concentrated cleaners, detergents and chemicals inaccessible.

Trash & leftovers

Bones, wrappers, spoiled food and hidden ingredients can create problems.

Garage & yard

Antifreeze, pesticides, fertilizers and other chemicals need secure storage.

Small objects

Socks, toys, corn cobs, string and other swallowable items can cause emergencies.

A safer home is often about prevention: store risky items high, closed, labeled and out of reach.

PetWise rule: If you are unsure whether something is safe, check a reliable veterinary source before giving or using it around your dog.

Your Dog's Emergency Info

Fill this page out, save a photo to your phone, and leave a copy with anyone who watches your dog.

DOG'S NAME

DATE OF BIRTH / AGE

WEIGHT

PRIMARY VETERINARIAN + PHONE

EMERGENCY VET + PHONE

CURRENT MEDICATIONS

KNOWN ALLERGIES / REACTIONS

MEDICAL CONDITIONS / IMPORTANT HISTORY

MICROCHIP NUMBER

PET INSURANCE / POLICY INFO

EMERGENCY CONTACT

You know the basics. Now build your PetWise toolkit.

This quick guide is only the beginning.

COMING NEXT

THE PETWISE PET PARENT HANDBOOK

- Expanded food safety reference
- Signs and changes worth noticing
- Everyday care checklists
- Vet visit and medication trackers
- Household safety guide
- Pet sitter emergency sheet
- Puppy and senior-dog reference pages
- Printable records and phone-friendly checklists

Our goal: help you know what to notice, what to track, what to avoid, and when to ask a veterinary professional for help.

FOLLOW PETWISE + WATCH FOR THE FULL HANDBOOK

Important: PetWise provides general educational information and is not a substitute for veterinary diagnosis or treatment. If your pet is ill, injured, has eaten something potentially toxic, or you are concerned about a sudden or severe change, contact a veterinarian promptly.